



FLAGSHIP CASE STUDY 01

Business Operations Diagnostic & Process Redesign

A cross-industry operating model for diagnosing workflow failure, redesigning handoffs, and making execution measurable.

AUTHOR	CASE TYPE	FOCUS
Nina Suico	Portfolio simulation	Business Operations Process Improvement Business Analysis

The operating problem

SCENARIO

A growing B2B services company has expanded faster than its operating model. Sales, delivery, finance, and leadership use different trackers and informal handoffs. Work moves, but ownership and status are difficult to see.

MANDATE

Diagnose where execution breaks, identify the business exposure, and design a practical future-state system that can be implemented without replacing the entire technology stack.

DESIGN PRINCIPLE

Fix operating logic before adding automation. A faster broken process is still broken, only now it arrives earlier.

WHAT THIS CASE DEMONSTRATES

Operational diagnosis

Turns fragmented symptoms into a prioritized root-cause view.

Process and control design

Defines stages, entry criteria, ownership, handoffs, and escalation.

Business analysis

Connects process failure to measurable operational and commercial exposure.

Implementation thinking

Sequences governance, workflow, reporting, and adoption work over 90 days.

Evidence note. The method is grounded in Nina Suico's documented work with SOPs, readiness trackers, CRM enablement, process maps, handoff design, management reporting, and cross-functional coordination. The company, data, diagnosis, targets, and roadmap in this case are synthetic.

Five lenses. One operating truth.

The diagnostic does not begin with a preferred tool. It begins with evidence about how work actually moves.

1	Demand	What enters the system, from whom, and with what information?
2	Flow	Where does work wait, loop, or move without a defined acceptance rule?
3	Ownership	Who decides, executes, approves, and resolves exceptions?
4	Control	Which risks require validation, escalation, or an audit trail?
5	Visibility	Which measures support decisions rather than decorate reports?

Evidence sources	Question answered
Stakeholder interviews	Where do teams compensate for the formal process?
CRM and tracker review	Which fields, dates, owners, and statuses can be trusted?
Work sample tracing	How does one item move from intake to completion?
SOP and template review	Do documented rules match actual decisions?
Exception analysis	Which failures repeat, and what business risk do they create?

Where work breaks today

The visible delay is not one bottleneck. It is the cumulative effect of missing entry criteria, implicit ownership, and disconnected status records.



SALES	Captures demand, but required information and qualification thresholds vary.	Risk: weak-fit work enters delivery.
OPERATIONS	Receives commitments through messages and meetings, then reconstructs context.	Risk: delay, rework, and disputed ownership.
FINANCE	Validates commercial details late because quote and approval evidence is dispersed.	Risk: billing friction and margin leakage.
LEADERSHIP	Reconciles status across systems and receives lagging summaries.	Risk: late intervention and unreliable forecasting.

Prioritize by exposure, not irritation

A diagnostic becomes actionable when each failure is tied to evidence, operational exposure, and a control response.

Failure mode	Signal in synthetic review	Business exposure	Priority
Incomplete intake	31% of sampled work items lacked one or more required fields.	Rework, weak scoping, avoidable follow-up.	Critical
Unclear ownership	26% had no accountable owner at the next stage.	Queue aging, duplicated effort, missed commitments.	Critical
Informal handoff	Acceptance criteria were absent in 4 of 5 traced journeys.	Context loss, revision loops, delivery friction.	High
Late commercial validation	Finance reviewed terms after solution commitments in 38% of sampled cases.	Margin risk, billing disputes, approval delays.	High
Fragmented status reporting	Four trackers required manual reconciliation.	Slow decisions, inconsistent forecasts, low trust.	High
No exception clock	Aged items were reviewed ad hoc rather than by threshold.	Late escalation and invisible service risk.	Medium

Interpretation. Technology is not the primary root cause. The dominant failure is missing operating governance: entry rules, decision rights, handoff acceptance, and exception thresholds.

One workflow. Explicit control points.

The redesigned model creates a single accountable path while allowing each team to retain the tools it already uses during the first implementation phase.



Decision-rights snapshot

Decision / activity	Sales	Operations	Finance	Leadership
Qualify opportunity	A/R	C	-	I
Confirm solution readiness	C	A/R	C	I
Approve commercial exception	C	C	R	A
Accept delivery handoff	C	A/R	I	I
Escalate aged or blocked work	R	R	C	A

A = Accountable | R = Responsible | C = Consulted | I = Informed

How the redesign creates business value

Targets are implementation hypotheses. They become claims only after baseline definitions, dated data, and post-change validation are retained.

KPI	Definition	Synthetic baseline	Validation target
Intake completeness	Complete required fields / total items	31% incomplete	< 5% incomplete
Ownership coverage	Items with accountable next-stage owner / total	26% unowned	> 98% owned
Handoff first-pass acceptance	Accepted without return / handoffs	Not measured	> 90%
Stage cycle time	Median exit timestamp - entry timestamp	Inconsistent timestamps	Stable stage baselines
Exception aging	Open exceptions beyond threshold / open exceptions	Ad hoc review	< 10% beyond threshold
Reporting reconciliation effort	Hours spent merging status sources per cycle	Four-source manual merge	Single governed view

CONTROL CHANGE

Required inputs, accountable owners, acceptance gates, exception clocks, governed timestamps.

OPERATING EFFECT

Less reconstruction, fewer bounced handoffs, earlier escalation, cleaner cycle-time evidence.

BUSINESS VALUE

More reliable commitments, lower coordination cost, reduced commercial leakage, faster management decisions.

Move from diagnosis to controlled adoption

The sequence protects the business from a common failure: launching tools before decision rules and data ownership are settled.

DAYS 1-15	ALIGN	Confirm scope, owners, baseline definitions, control risks, and decision rights.	Output: Signed process charter, issue register, data dictionary.
DAYS 16-35	DESIGN	Finalize stage rules, required fields, handoff acceptance, RACI, exception thresholds, and reporting logic.	Output: Future-state map, SOP set, forms, control matrix.
DAYS 36-60	PILOT	Run one service line through the model, track exceptions, and revise unclear rules.	Output: Pilot log, UAT findings, revised workflow, training materials.
DAYS 61-90	SCALE	Roll out by cohort, monitor adoption and KPI integrity, and establish monthly governance.	Output: Dashboard, governance cadence, benefits-validation plan.

WHAT A HIRING MANAGER CAN INFER	ROLE ALIGNMENT
Nina can structure an ambiguous operating problem, trace work across functions, separate symptoms from control failures, design a usable future state, and define how impact should be measured without inventing results.	Business Operations Business Analysis Process Improvement Project Delivery Operations Strategy

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